Security questionnaires: the one-page guide for reps

Use the desk for any security or IT questionnaire from a prospect or customer: a spreadsheet, a portal export or a list of questions in an email. It answers only from approved answers and tells you who to ask about the rest.

How to use it

1. Put the questions in a sheet, one question per row, in the buyer's order.
2. Send the sheet to the desk through the form or inbox your team set up.
3. You get the same sheet back with a Yes, No or Partly, an answer, its sources and a status on every row.
4. Read every row. Ready rows are approved wording: if one looks wrong for this buyer, send it back to its owner instead of editing it.
5. Rows waiting for an owner: the owner has already been asked. Chase after one working day.
6. Return the sheet through the buyer's own channel. Point them to the trust centre for evidence.

What the statuses mean

Ready: approved sentences, checked word for word.

Ready, evidence under NDA: send the answer; the report itself goes through the trust centre once an NDA is signed.

Waiting for an owner: the library could not prove an answer. Do not fill it in yourself.

Answered by an owner: a person wrote it. It is going to the library so next time it is Ready.

Not answered in writing: offer a call with the owner instead.

Never

✗ Paste a buyer's questionnaire, or our answers, into a public AI tool.

✗ Edit a Ready answer before sending it. If it looks wrong, send it back to its owner so the library gets fixed.

✗ Answer price, contract terms, incident history or future plans yourself.

✗ Email audit reports, test reports or other NDA evidence. They go through the trust centre.

✗ Promise a date for something that is not built yet.

Who owns what

- **Head of Security**: certifications, testing, monitoring, incidents, and any cell that gives instructions to AI tools.
- **Head of Engineering**: hosting, encryption, logging, continuity.
- **Head of Product**: features, integrations and anything about the future.
- **Data Protection Lead**: personal data and AI data flows.
- **Legal**: contract terms, audit rights, service levels.
- **Sales lead**: pricing and discounts.

Portals with character limits

Paste the first sentence of the Ready answer and add "Full answer available on request". Never shorten it by rewording.

Prepared by Hemanth Vallamkonda as part of an application to ThreatAware. Independent and illustrative; uses public information only. Written for the questionnaire desk demonstration, whose vendor and answer library are fictional.